

remain cautious about spending.

Diagnostics chains have reported double-digit annual growth in preventive health screenings with younger urban consumers increasingly accounting for first-time tests.

“Preventive healthcare in India has moved firmly into the mainstream, with post-Covid awareness accelerating the shift towards early detection and proactive health management across age groups. Consumers are far more engaged in monitoring their health regularly, and this has also brought younger cohorts, including Gen Z, into the diagnostics ecosystem earlier, through first-time preventive screenings driven by fitness awareness, lifestyle choices and digital engagement. This shift in consumer behaviour has been a key growth driver for Metropolis Healthcare,” says Surendran Chemmenkotil, Managing Director of Metropolis Healthcare.

Social media is part of this environment, but not always as a driver of trust. While platforms introduce ideas around nutrition and fitness, many respondents appear sceptical of exaggerated claims. Personal experience and peer feedback carry more weight than endorsements.

Further, factors such as brand perception, ease of access and speed of availability influence choices.

“E-commerce platforms and brand communication, along with peer influence and social conformity, play a role in shaping decisions. All these elements need to be considered together when assessing health behaviour among younger populations,” says Dr Parikh.

The survey also points to a change in consumption priorities. Status-led purchases appear less central to this age group. Brand recognition matters, but usefulness and perceived health impact increasingly shape decisions.



“With AI and online tools becoming more accessible, some young people may delay seeking professional medical advice”

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PROGRAM



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**SURENDRAN
CHEMMENKOTIL**
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ATTENTION SANS ALARM

A 2025 report by descriptor Burson titled *Gen Z: Calling for Healthcare Connection and Change* finds that Indian Gen Z is approaching healthcare with a largely positive and engaged mindset. The report shows that 78% of respondents experience positive emotions when actively managing their health, pointing to a stronger focus on preventive care, mental health awareness and regular health decision-making rather than crisis-driven treatment.

While digital tools play a growing role, trust in traditional healthcare remains strong, with a majority preferring in-person consultations and relying on doctors and hospitals. Cost, access and misinformation continue to pose challenges, even as health engagement deepens among young adults.

For public health, this behaviour carries implications. A population that reads labels and seeks information is more responsive to preventive measures. India's Gen Z is not rejecting consumption, but it is spending with more caution and asking more questions. As this group grows older and earns more, these habits are likely to influence demand across food, healthcare and lifestyle categories, says Mitra.

Across urban India, a growing number of young households including GenZ are also changing their approach to cookware. Non-stick and aluminium utensils, once seen as modern and convenient, are increasingly being replaced by stainless steel pots and pans.

For Gen Z and millennials, health concerns are extending beyond ingredients to the materials used in everyday cooking. **BT**

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